CHECKLIST / SELF-ASSESSMENT

QA Interview Preparation Checklist

Check an item when you can explain the concept, apply it in a scenario and give a clear example. This is a practice guide, not an exam.

TARGET ROLE: _____ INTERVIEW DATE: _____ LAST REVIEW: _____

TIP | Say your answers out loud; don't just tick familiar words.

01 TESTING FUNDAMENTALS

- ☐ Explain SDLC, STLC and where QA contributes throughout delivery.
- ☐ Distinguish verification from validation with a practical example.
- ☐ Compare functional, regression, retesting, smoke, sanity and exploratory testing.
- ☐ Explain severity versus priority and who helps decide each.
- ☐ Describe a defect lifecycle, triage and what makes a report actionable.
- ☐ Explain positive, negative and boundary testing with examples.
- ☐ Prioritise tests when time, people or environments are limited.
- ☐ Describe UAT and how it differs from system testing.

02 TEST DESIGN & DEFECT REPORTING

- ☐ Write clear test cases with preconditions, steps, data and expected results.
- ☐ Use equivalence partitions and boundary value analysis.
- ☐ Test success, failure, validation and permission scenarios for a login page.
- ☐ Write a reproducible bug report with expected vs actual behavior and evidence.
- ☐ Explain how to investigate a defect that cannot be reproduced.
- ☐ Describe which areas you would regress after a checkout fix.
- ☐ Explain how you would test ambiguous or changing requirements.

PRACTICE PROMPT “How would you test a login page?” Answer in 60–90 seconds; include risks, test data, happy paths and failure cases.

TECHNICAL CHECKLIST / PAGE 2

Technical QA Readiness

Focus on what you can actually demonstrate. If you are new to a tool, describe what you have practiced rather than claiming professional experience.

03 API TESTING

- ☐ Explain GET, POST, PUT, PATCH and DELETE and when to use each.
- ☐ Interpret common status codes and distinguish transport success from business success.
- ☐ Check request bodies, response fields, headers and content types.
- ☐ Distinguish authentication from authorization and test access controls.
- ☐ Design negative cases: missing fields, invalid payloads, expired tokens and wrong methods.
- ☐ Validate pagination, filtering, sorting and data persistence.
- ☐ Explain idempotency, retries and duplicate-operation risks.
- ☐ Describe a Postman collection with environments, variables and assertions.
- ☐ Investigate an API defect using request/response evidence and logs.

04 SQL & DATA VALIDATION

- ☐ Write SELECT queries with WHERE, ORDER BY, LIKE and NULL checks.
- ☐ Explain INNER JOIN versus LEFT JOIN with a QA example.
- ☐ Use COUNT, SUM, GROUP BY and HAVING for data checks.
- ☐ Detect duplicate, orphaned or unexpectedly missing records.
- ☐ Check data consistency across the UI, API and database.
- ☐ Explain transactions, rollbacks and read-only validation precautions.
- ☐ Describe how to verify that a successful API update was actually persisted.

PRACTICE PROMPT “The API returns 200, but the customer's order is missing.” Explain the evidence you would collect and the checks you would run.

FINAL CHECKLIST / PAGE 3

Interview & Scenario Readiness

Prepare concise stories showing your thinking, the evidence you gathered and the outcome. Adapt the depth to Junior, Mid-Level or Senior QA expectations.

05 REAL-WORLD SCENARIOS

- ☐ Explain how you choose high-risk tests before a release.
- ☐ Describe a challenging defect: investigation, evidence and resolution.
- ☐ Explain what you would do when requirements are incomplete.
- ☐ Describe how you communicate a release concern to stakeholders.
- ☐ Explain your approach to production incidents and validating fixes.
- ☐ For senior roles: discuss test strategy, trade-offs and quality metrics.

06 INTERVIEW-DAY PREPARATION

- ☐ Prepare a 60-second introduction focused on your actual QA experience.
- ☐ Choose two STAR examples: a defect investigation and a delivery challenge.
- ☐ Practice explaining one test design and one bug report without reading notes.
- ☐ Prepare examples involving API or database checks relevant to the role.
- ☐ Read the job description and connect your experience to its requirements.
- ☐ Prepare thoughtful questions about risks, releases, tools and team processes.
- ☐ Check your interview link, audio, camera, internet and a quiet location.
- ☐ Be ready to say what you do not know and how you would investigate it.

FINAL PRACTICE Choose three unchecked items. Write one action for each, and rehearse the answer aloud. Recheck the list before your next interview.

My three priorities:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____